

THE ALCHEMIST HIS PRACTISE

*Wherein is declared the Vertues of
Hearbes, Mineralls, and Chymicall Preparations*

By a Student in the Spagyrick Art

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CHAPTER IV

Of the Chirurgion his Art

IT hath beene shewed by Paracelsus, that ye physician who knoweth not the starres can never rightly compound his medicaments. For the quintessence of everie thing lyeth hidden, and must bee drawne forth by calcination.

The alembick being set upon a gentle fire, the spirit ascendeth and is gathered in the receiver. This the ancients called aqua vitae, and helde it soveraigne against all putrefaction.

* See the Basilica Chymica of Croll, lib. ii, cap. vii.

Nowe the chirurgion, having his simples ready,
shall marke well the humours of his patient,
and by the doctrine of Paracelsus discern
whether the quintessence be wanting.

Take of the mineralls such as are perfected by nature, and let them bee calcined in the alembick until the spirit ascendeth. So shall the chirurgeon have his medicaments ready.

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Of the vertues of hearbes much hath beene
written, yet fewe have shewed how the
quintessence is drawne. The soveraigne
remedie lyeth in calcination, saith Paracelsus.

Let the practitioner marke that putrefaction
goeth before generation, and that the alembick
is the chirurgion his surest instrument in all
the operations of this spagyrick art.